

F5 Daily Briefing - Thursday, July 16, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS
TRACKED

13

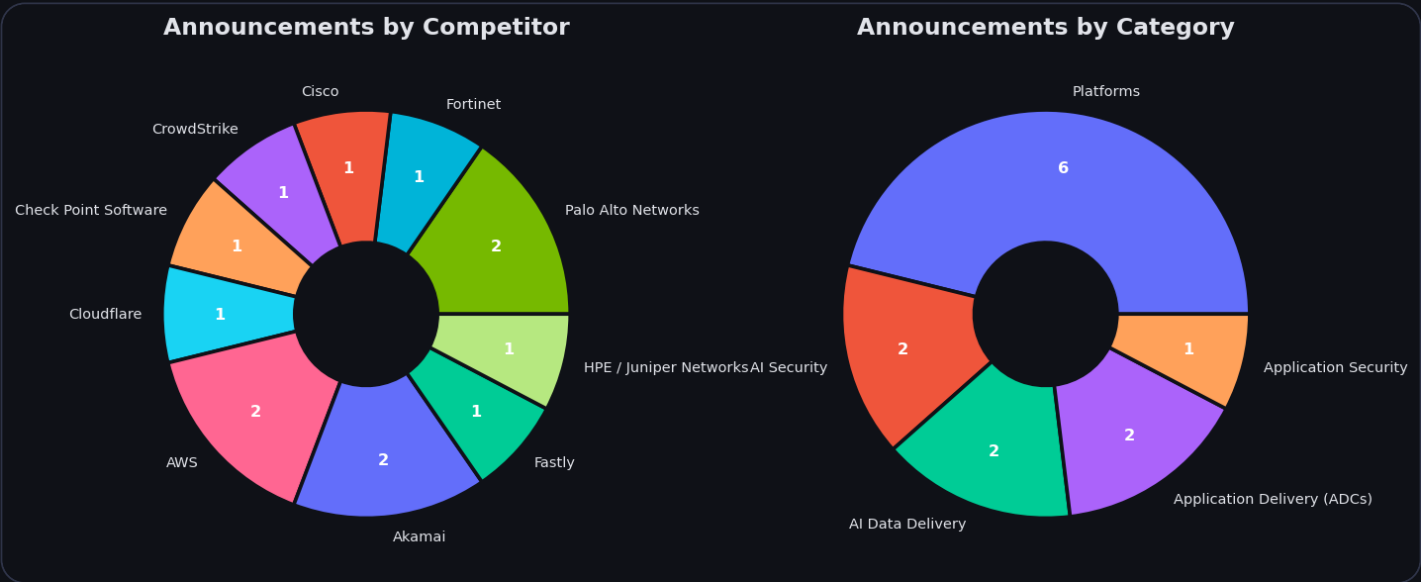
ANNOUNCEMENTS

10

ACTIVE

5

ACTIVE CATEGORIES



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (13)

PARTNERSHIP

Palo Alto Networks

2026-07-16

Palo Alto Networks and AT&T Deliver Quantum-Resilient SASE Fabric

Palo Alto Networks and AT&T Business unveiled a Quantum-Resilient SASE Fabric that embeds native Post-Quantum Cryptography into the Prisma SASE platform. Using a Service Provider Interconnect, quantum-safe traffic traverses AT&T's private network core without public-internet tunnels, preserving performance. The offering adds automated PQC policy orchestration, hybrid PKI, and zero-touch provisioning, positioning it as a practical path to quantum readiness across 5G, fiber, and legacy underlays.

<https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/2026/07/palo-alto-networks-and-att-delivering-quantum-resilient-sase-fabric/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Palo Alto Networks**

2026-07-16

Prisma AIRS AI Gateway Reaches General Availability

Palo Alto Networks announced general availability of Prisma AIRS AI Gateway, a unified AI control plane placing a single inline enforcement point between AI interactions and backend models. It delivers AI governance, identity, and runtime controls at scale, building on Portkey-derived capabilities. The gateway lets existing coding assistants, enterprise agents, and copilots keep operating while security and governance shift to the infrastructure layer.

<https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/2026/07/announcing-general-availability-of-prisma-air-ai-gateway/>

SECURITY ADVISORY**Fortinet**

2026-07-16

CISA Adds Actively Exploited FortiSandbox Flaws to KEV Catalog

CISA added two FortiSandbox vulnerabilities (CVE-2026-39808 and CVE-2026-25089) to its Known Exploited Vulnerabilities catalog after in-the-wild exploitation, mandating that federal agencies patch by July 19. The flaws enable OS command execution and injection across multiple FortiSandbox versions; Fortinet released fixes in 4.4.9 and 5.0.6. Agencies unable to mitigate affected cloud variants were advised to discontinue use.

<https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/cisa-urgent-patch-fortinet/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**Cisco**

2026-07-16

Cisco Positions Cisco IQ to Restore the Defender's Advantage

Cisco detailed how Cisco IQ, now used by over 5,000 organizations, provides complete asset visibility and actionable insights to move teams from reactive to proactive security amid frontier AI-driven threats. Available to existing support customers via SaaS, it underpins Cisco's Support and Professional Services. Cisco also introduced Resilient Infrastructure Services spanning exposure assessment, zero-trust modernization, and defense resiliency.

<https://blogs.cisco.com/customerexperience/frontier-attacks-just-ended-the-defenders-advantage-cisco-iq-is-how-you-get-it-back>

ACQUISITION**CrowdStrike**

2026-07-16

CrowdStrike Expands Schwarz Digits Partnership, to Acquire XM Cyber IP

CrowdStrike expanded its partnership with Schwarz Digits to deliver the AI-native Falcon platform on the STACKIT sovereign cloud across Europe, aligning with NIS2 and the EU Cyber Resilience Act. CrowdStrike will also acquire XM Cyber's intellectual property—over 45 patents covering attack-path visualization—to strengthen Falcon Exposure Management. XM Cyber remains a standalone business under license; the deal is expected to close in the second half of fiscal 2027.

<https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/press-releases/crowdstrike-and-schwarz-digits-expand-strategic-partnership-to-deliver-sovereign-cybersecurity-across-europe/>

THREAT REPORT**Check Point Software**

2026-07-16

Check Point AI Security Report 2026 Warns of Autonomous AI Attackers

Check Point released its Annual AI Security Report 2026, warning that AI has shifted from assisting attackers to autonomously executing live intrusions with minimal human direction. The report documents AI running thousands of commands across sessions and a collapse of vulnerability response windows to hours. Check Point urges three imperatives: security for AI, security by AI via ThreatCloud AI, and security with AI to govern workforce usage.

<https://www.checkpoint.com/press-releases/check-point-research-ai-has-crossed-from-assistant-to-operator-rewriting-the-rules-of-autonomous-ai-cyber-attack-and-defense/>

PRODUCT LAUNCH**Cloudflare**

2026-07-16

Cloudflare Launches x402 Monetization Gateway for AI Agents

Cloudflare introduced a Monetization Gateway that charges AI crawlers directly for data using the open x402 standard developed with Coinbase. When a machine requests data, Cloudflare returns an HTTP 402 with a price; the agent pays and resubmits with proof of payment to receive the content, all within normal web requests. Settlement starts with USDC, with support explored for Bitcoin and Lightning, aligning revenue with machine-driven data access.

<https://techdefused.com/a/1f91874/cloudflare-wants-ai-software-to-pay-websites-directly-for-the-data-it-takes-a-fr>

PRODUCT UPDATE**AWS**

2026-07-16

AWS Backup Extends Logically Air-Gapped Vaults to Six New Regions

AWS Backup expanded logically air-gapped vault support to six additional Regions, including Asia Pacific (Taipei, Malaysia, New Zealand, Thailand), Mexico (Central), and Canada West (Calgary). The vaults provide immutable, isolated backups locked by default and encrypted with AWS-owned or customer-managed keys. Features include cross-account and cross-Region copy, RAM-based vault sharing for recovery, and multi-party approval to protect access during account compromise.

<https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/07/aws-backup-logically-air-gapped-vault-regions/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**AWS**

2026-07-16

Amazon S3 Event Notifications Now Include System-Generated Tags

AWS announced that Amazon S3 Event Notifications now include system-generated tags across all destinations —EventBridge, SQS, SNS, and Lambda. These service-applied bucket tags let customers filter events across many buckets with a single EventBridge rule, removing the need to enumerate bucket names. The capability is available for general-purpose buckets via Console, SDK, or CLI at no additional cost.

<https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/07/amazon-s3-event-notifications-system-generated-tags/>

PRODUCT UPDATE**Akamai**

2026-07-16

Akamai Enterprise Application Access Adds Workforce Protector DLP

Akamai's July 16 Enterprise Application Access update introduces secure access to HTTP applications with Akamai Workforce Protector (AWP) data loss prevention. The integration enables granular DLP for users reaching EAA-brokered HTTP apps through browsers running the AWP extension. The AWP-DLP capability is in limited availability and targeted at HTTP applications.

<https://techdocs.akamai.com/eaa/changelog/july-16-2026-enterprise-application-access-updates>

THREAT REPORT**Akamai**

2026-07-16

Akamai Research: APAC AI Commerce Boom Drives Surge in Bot and API Attacks

Akamai's latest State of the Internet report found APAC's AI-powered commerce growth is fueling automated abuse, with bot activity targeting regional commerce up 63% in 2025—the highest regional increase. Commerce made up roughly 38% of APAC AI bot traffic in the second half of 2025, and Layer 7 DDoS attacks on commerce apps grew 39% to 361 billion events. Akamai urges risk-based, low-friction defenses to separate malicious from legitimate automation.

<https://businessnewsforprofit.com/technology/akamai-research-apacs-ai-powered-commerce-boom-fuels-surge-in-bot-and-api-attacks/>

CORPORATE**Fastly**

2026-07-16

Fastly Announces 2026 Investor Day for September 22

Fastly announced it will host its 2026 Investor Day on September 22 at the Nasdaq MarketSite in New York City, with a live webcast at 1:00 PM ET. The half-day hybrid program will feature executives presenting updates on strategy, product roadmap across edge compute, delivery and security, financials, and a refined medium-term outlook. In-person attendance is limited, and a webcast replay will be available afterward.

<https://investors.fastly.com/news-releases/news-release-details/fastly-announces-upcoming-investor-day>

PRODUCT UPDATE**HPE / Juniper Networks**

2026-07-16

HPE Expands Self-Driving Networks for AI Infrastructure

HPE announced an expansion of its self-driving networking portfolio with new AI-powered features spanning edge, campus, data center, and AI factory environments. The updated platform automates network operations, adds AI-driven threat detection and policy automation, and delivers real-time analytics with a consolidated view for hybrid infrastructure. HPE positions the enhancements to support scalable, autonomous, AI-ready networks that improve performance and reduce downtime as enterprises scale AI workloads.

<https://www.precedenceresearch.com/news/hpe-self-driving-networks-ai-infrastructure>